



Turn left at the tree

Giant sequoias are the world's biggest trees. In some Californian parks, the trees are so wide that they have roads cut through them.

Old and gnarled

The oldest tree thought to be still alive is a bristlecone pine. It is almost 5,000 years old, but, because they grow in dry places, even young ones look wrinkled!



Oh so rare

In the 1800s, the Lady's slipper orchid was picked almost to extinction. Just one plant was left in the wild. Fortunately, scientists have been able to use its seeds to plant more.

Strange facts

- There is one plant that grows so fast you can hear it creaking! Giant bamboo can grow 1 m (3 ft) each day.
- The biggest seed in the world is the coco-de-mer. It weighs up to 20 kg (45 lb), the same as a six-year-old girl.

Keep on twisting

The weirdest plant of all is found in the Namibian desert. It has just two leaves that are dry and woody, but they never stop growing so they end up all twisted.

